

transitory and finally meaningless and fail to cherish what is beyond calculation, indeed eternal.

That message, I think, is what Joseph Heller captured in that powerful single word *enough*—not only our worship of wealth and the growing corruption of our professional ethics but ultimately the subversion of our character and values. And so that's where I want to start, with what I know best: how my own life has shaped my character and values, and how my character and values have shaped my life. As you will see, I've been given enough in countless ways.

Growing Up

Perhaps the best place to begin is with my heritage: heavily Scottish, which may be enough to explain my apparently legendary thriftiness. The Armstrongs—ancestors of my grandmother on my mother's side—came to America from Scotland in the early 1700s to farm here (a wonderful reminder that nearly all of us are descendants of immigrants). I've always thought of my great-grandfather—Philander Banister Armstrong—as my spiritual progenitor. He was an industry leader, but did his best to reform first the fire insurance industry (in an 1868 speech in St. Louis, he implored, "Gentlemen, cut your costs"), and then the life insurance industry. His spirited 1917 diatribe—258 pages long—was entitled *A License to Steal: How the Life Insurance Industry Robs Our Own People of Billions*. The final sentence: "The patient [the insurance industry] has a cancer. The virus is in the blood. He is not only sick unto death, but he is dangerous to the community. Call in the undertaker."

The Hipkins family—my mother's family—were Virginians who also came to America early in the eighteenth century; some of their progeny would serve in the Confederate States Army. My Hipkins grandparents, John Clifton Hipkins ("The Skipper") and Effie Armstrong Hipkins ("Chick"), were colorful characters who expected their three children and six grandchildren to be good citizens and to make the most of themselves.